AskAI cheat sheet

Twelve commands cover a working day. askai with no command is askai next. Everything else is askai help more or askai help all.

How AskAI fits together

Run AskAI in a terminal for local checks and file generation. Opening an AskAI skill or slash command in an AI chat uses model tokens. askai go launches an AI tool; that session uses the tool's model allowance.

AskAI stores local session state under .ai-work/ and excludes it through .git/info/exclude. Project guidance remains in the repository. Cursor must open the initialized project as its workspace root to find .cursor/commands/askai-cli.md.

The loop

Phase	Sequence
Once per machine	askai install then askai check --fix then askai infra. Retry only failed items with askai install --retry
Once per project	askai init or askai project refresh, then askai project hide-local, then askai check
Each task	askai next, askai prompt, askai go <tool> "task", askai run -- <command>, askai errors, then askai diff
Taking a break	askai break, complete the draft with askai handoff "next step", then askai clear when it says safe
Coming back	askai resume --copy then askai next
Weekly	askai savings --week, askai check, askai mcp, then askai plugins

I want to... run...

I want to	Run
See what to do	askai next
Turn an idea into a task	askai prompt "idea" --copy
Start Cursor, Claude Code, Codex, or Antigravity	askai go <tool> "task" --tier chore|build|lead
Keep a noisy build or test	askai run -- <command>
Read the failure	askai errors
Leave the session	askai break
Finish the note	askai handoff "next step"
Come back	askai resume --copy
See spend	askai savings
See whether a tool is worth it	askai plugins
Turn MCP servers off	askai mcp off <name>
Fix what AskAI can fix	askai check --fix

The twelve

Command	Use when	Form
askai next	you are not sure what to do	askai next
askai go	start the coding app on a task	askai go <tool> "task"
askai prompt	turn a rough idea into a task	askai prompt "idea"
askai run	a build or test prints too much	askai run -- <command>
askai check	just installed, or something feels off	askai check
askai break	you are stepping away	askai break
askai resume	you are back from a break	askai resume
askai handoff	finish the note for the next session	askai handoff ["next step"]
askai savings	cost feels high	askai savings
askai project	this folder needs its pack	askai project <sub>
askai install	set up or finish this machine	askai install
askai help	you need the exact command	askai help [command]

Global flags, on any command: --yes --dry-run --json --project. A command shows at most four of its own flags. The rest are askai help <command> --advanced.

When you need one more

Command	Use when
askai errors	the last build failed
askai diff	you want the change list
askai clear	the chat is long (over 60%)
askai snapshot	save work without a commit
askai weigh	a file may be too big to read
askai route	you want the tier, not a launch
askai models	the model or effort looks wrong
askai mcp	too many tool servers are on
askai plugins	deciding whether a tool is worth keeping
askai convert	a PDF or Office file should be text
askai update	AskAI itself is old
askai tools	an installed tool is old
askai why	one finding needs the reason
askai stop	an agent CLI is still running

Complete command index

The commands below are also implemented. This table plus the twelve and the additional commands above covers every name in askai help --list. Use askai help <command> --advanced for less common flags.

Command	Purpose	Form
askai cli	Prepare a project from the chat folder, then open an AskAI-only terminal. AI review is opt-in.	askai cli [--prepare] [--launch] [--review] [--path DIR] [--about TEXT]
askai status	Status in four environment columns, or one selected environment.	askai status [codex|antigravity|cursor|claude] [--host HOST] [--json] [--brief]
askai setup	Short check after install: which hosts are present, check counts, and whether the file validator passed.	askai setup [dir] [--yes]
askai bootstrap	Show a personal devcontainer setup; --repo writes a post-create script into this project.	askai bootstrap [dir] [--profile P] [--repo]
askai ask	Offline answers on etiquette and the research: the rule, why, the command in each tool, and what AskAI automates.	askai ask <words>
askai start	Start a task: ledger entry with tool, task, branch and last commit.	askai start --tool T --task "..." [--repo DIR]
askai session	The per-repo ledger in .ai-work/: entries, handoff, measurements, report. askai start, askai break and askai resume are the daily names for those three actions.	askai session init|pause|status|finish|measure|report|quota [plan|report] [options]
askai scaffold	Write the files every agent reads: AGENTS.md, CLAUDE.md, docs/ai/PROJECT_PROFILE.md, .cursorignore, .ai-work/. Never overwrites.	askai scaffold [dir] [--dry-run]
askai suggest	Recommend a profile from the files in a folder.	askai suggest [dir]
askai profiles	What each profile installs.	askai profiles
askai set	Select a project for this terminal or set a persistent fallback.	askai set project NAME | project --clear | default NAME | default --clear
askai shell	Enable terminal-scoped project selection in a shell.	askai shell init powershell|bash|zsh | install SHELL --path PROFILE | uninstall
askai tips	The cheat sheet, offline, per tool. peak says whether Claude is in peak hours now.	askai tips [claude|codex|agy|cursor|session|habits|peak]
askai test	Run the safe commands one by one, print a short status, and write one capture file.	askai test [--out FILE] [--json] [--real] [--notty] [--compare FILE]
askai statusline	Claude Code's status line command (reads the session JSON on stdin): model, context, cache; records snapshots for askai savings.	askai statusline [--demo]
askai restore	List backup timestamps, or restore supported configuration files from one backup.	askai restore [stamp] [--dry-run] [--yes]

askai uninstall	Remove only what AskAI added: keys still holding AskAI's value, its marked blocks, its own files and registrations.	askai uninstall [--only ID,ID] [--dry-run]
askai version	Print the AskAI version.	askai version [--all] [--json]
askai init	Scan eligible first-party source files, consult detected frameworks' official docs, write a compact project knowledge pack and register its path.	askai init [dir] [--name NAME] [--path DIR] [--about "..."] [--type T] [--yes] [--refresh] [--offline] [--dry-run] [--build "cmd"] [--test "cmd"]
askai review	Show which project inputs changed since host AI review; record completion after review.	askai review [status|done] [--project NAME] [--json] [--all]
askai map	Regenerate docs/ai/PROJECT_MAP.md from README folder descriptions and conventional names; preserve purposes you edited.	askai map [dir] [--dry-run] [--diff]
askai audit	The seven-point token audit: memory files, tools and proxies, model and effort, hooks, subagents, scheduled work, cache reuse.	askai audit [dir] [--tool claude|codex|cursor|agy] [--project name|dir] [--json]
askai infra	Tools and repository files.	askai infra [dir] [--json]
askai guide	The etiquette for each moment of work, offline.	askai guide [install|start|work|break|resume|clear|compact|cache|models|subagen
askai docs	Find AskAI documents or check generated command documentation for drift.	askai docs [install|architecture|projects|guide|cheatsheet|changelog|preview|cont [--print]
askai context	What to do at this context level: continue, hand off, clear. 60% is a warning, not an order to compact.	askai context <percent> | --used N --window M
askai todo	Remaining setup and project-review steps: sign-ins, restarts, app settings, model IDs, one-time plugin steps, and repository facts that need confirmation. Checkable items clear themselves.	askai todo [dir] [--all] | askai todo done <id> | askai todo undo <id>
askai graph	Print the Mermaid architecture diagram from docs/ai/ARCHITECTURE.md and open it in the browser when the terminal is interactive.	askai graph [dir] | query "question" [--timeout 10] [--budget 600] | status [--json]
askai chat	Where to paste a short standing instruction in Claude chat, ChatGPT, and Gemini, and how the four coding apps are set up instead.	askai chat [claude|chatgpt|gemini|code] [--copy]
askai direction	Print the one-screen working loop and the most useful command choices.	askai direction

Legacy spellings continue, etiquette, checkpoint, work, peak, projects, and cheat still route to their current commands. Prefer resume, guide, session pause, guide work, tips peak, project list, and direction in new scripts.

Which command, when

You are	Next command
Not sure	askai next
About to edit	askai go <tool> "task"

About to build or test	askai run -- <command>
Over 60% context	askai handoff "next step" then askai clear
Stepping away	askai break
Back	askai resume
Looking at cost	askai savings
Something feels off	askai check

Inside each coding app

Purpose	Claude Code	Codex	Antigravity	Cursor
What fills the context	/context	/status	/context	/context
Usage	/usage	/status	/usage	Dashboard, Usage
New task	/clear	/new	/clear	/new
Keep a long chat	/compact keep: goal, files, test	/compact	new chat plus a handoff	/summarize
Plan before editing	/plan	/plan	/plan	/plan

Exit the coding app with its own /exit. That returns you to the terminal. exit at the askai> prompt leaves the AskAI terminal.

Local files AskAI writes stay out of git through .git/info/exclude (askai project hide-local). AskAI does not edit a tracked .gitignore.

Optional tools (RTK, Context Mode, Headroom, Graphify, Context7, Repomix) install only with askai install --add ID. RTK, Headroom, and Context Mode cost more in the measured studies. Do not add them to save tokens.